SCIENCE DEPARTMENT • SCIENCE LITERACY & LESSON INTERNALIZATION

PLC AGENDA

Writing Benchmark → Anticipated Student Thinking → Feedback + Student Action

Science Literacy Evidence Cycle — Begin with one standards-aligned writing benchmark and plan how students will use feedback to strengthen the same task.

MONDAY, OCTOBER 26, 2026 | **41 MINUTES** | **GRADES 9–12 SCIENCE • BRING FORMS & EVIDENCE**

TODAY'S OUTCOME Leave with one upcoming writing benchmark/task, a clear bar for mastery, one anticipated student response or need, one feedback prompt, and one explicit student action to carry into Tuesday and Wednesday.

WHY THIS PLC MATTERS The benchmark task is most useful when teachers anticipate the science thinking and literacy moves it requires before students complete it. Today makes the task, success criteria, likely responses, feedback, and student action visible without lowering the science demand.

PROTOCOL CONNECTION
Every Day Questions 1, 3, and 4: clarify the task, criteria, anticipated thinking, student experience, and feedback. Team Deep Dive Steps 2–4: plan access, student action, and evidence to collect.

WHAT TO BRING
One upcoming writing benchmark, CER, model explanation, investigation response, or data-analysis task; the lesson plan; source/article/data/model; anticipated or exemplar response; success criteria; colored highlighters if useful; Lesson Internalization Tool. Optional: a related unit-test standard/question for context only.

FOCUS TO PROTECT
Use CUBS and color-coded CER only as brief routines that make the task and student thinking visible. They are not separate assignments, grading systems, or disconnected activities.

TODAY'S PLC PLAN

TIME (MIN)	FOCUS	WHAT TO DO	PRODUCT / CHECK
0:00–4:00	**Reconnect to the weekly evidence cycle**	Restate the priority standard/skill and keep one benchmark task at the center from planning through Friday evidence review.	**Evidence story**
4:00–10:00	**Clarify the benchmark + bar**	Use the actual writing task to name the prompt, source/evidence, student product, success criteria, and what students must make visible.	**Task + criteria**
10:00–17:00	**Analyze the source and response demand**	Use CUBS on the source and CER on an exemplar or anticipated response only where those routines clarify what students must read, select, and explain.	**Visible thinking**
17:00–25:00	**Anticipate student thinking**	Name a likely partial response, misconception, access need, or evidence/reasoning confusion that matters most for the benchmark.	**Anticipated need**
25:00–36:00	**Protected course-alike planning**	Plan one feedback prompt that sends students back to the evidence or science idea, then name the student action: revise, annotate, add, explain, compare, or correct.	**Feedback + action**
36:00–41:00	**Close + carry forward**	Prepare the same task, one criterion, anticipated response, feedback prompt, student action, and a small calibration item for Tuesday and Wednesday.	**Calibration set**

PROTECTED INDIVIDUAL WORK WITH COLLEAGUE SUPPORT

WORK WITH COLLEAGUES

WHAT TO DO Use the protected block to internalize the benchmark and plan independently first; then use colleagues to sharpen one anticipated student need, feedback prompt, and student action while keeping students responsible for the science thinking.

1. **Select the same upcoming benchmark:** Use one writing task, source, student product, and priority standard/skill already connected to course planning.
2. **State the bar for mastery:** Name the criteria and what a successful claim, evidence use, reasoning, language, or representation makes visible.
3. **Analyze source + anticipated response:** Use CUBS/CER only where they make the literacy and science-thinking demand easier to see.
4. **Name one anticipated need:** Identify the partial response, access need, evidence issue, or reasoning gap students may experience.
5. **Plan feedback + student action:** Write a prompt that returns students to the task and state the visible action students will take next.

USE THIS REFERENCE DURING GROUP WORK

BEGIN WITH THE BENCHMARK
Keep the task, priority skill, source/evidence, student product, and criteria visible. The task—not a generic routine—drives the planning conversation.

MAKE THINKING VISIBLE
CUBS can clarify the source; color-coded CER can clarify the response. Use either routine only when it helps students locate, use, and explain science evidence.

FEEDBACK MUST LEAD TO ACTION
Plan a criterion-based prompt that asks students to return to the evidence, explain, revise, compare, or correct without being given the answer.

COLLABORATION IN PRACTICE Protect time for thoughtful individual work; use respectful, student-centered feedback to make the next decision clearer.

TEACHER RUBRIC CONNECTION **Standard I: I-A-4 Well-Structured Lessons • Standard II: II-A-2 Student Engagement • Standard II: II-D-2 High Expectations • Standard IV: IV-C-1 Professional Collaboration**

